

Flow check: A Better Way

2026-07-12 中英对照阅读版

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神的子民曾亲眼见证祂的大能。祂救他们脱离奴役，带领他们穿过旷野，从天上赐下食物，又使磐石流出水来。然而，他们仍然不断怀疑祂。他们埋怨祂和他们的领袖摩西，于是毒蛇遍布营地。但那些仰望上帝恩典救法的人得以幸免，这预表着那位有一天要来医治并拯救属祂之人的救主。如今，一个异教先知出现了，执意要再次引诱上帝的子民走入歧途。

God's people had seen His power. He had rescued them from slavery, led them through the wilderness, provided food from heaven and water from a rock. Yet they continued to doubt Him. They grumbled against Him and their leader, Moses, and venomous snakes filled the camp. But those who looked to God's gracious remedy were spared, pointing to the One who would one day come to heal and save His own. Now, a pagan prophet has come along, set on leading God's people astray again.

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如果你每周都在收看并且做笔记，那你基本上就是一名属灵的海豹突击队员了。所以，真棒！无论从哪里观看，或以何种方式加入我们，我很高兴你今天能成为 Mariners Church 的一分子。我猜你属于两类人中的一类。第一种，你是一个会留意仪表盘警示灯的人；要么第二种，你会忽略仪表盘上的警示灯。如果你会留意仪表盘上的警示灯，请在聊天区告诉我们，好吗？因为这些人都是好基督徒。

And if you've been watching every week and taking notes, you're basically a spiritual Navy SEAL. So way to go. And no matter where you're watching from or how you're joining us, I am just glad you're part of Mariners Church today. And my guess is that you fall into one of two categories of people. One, you're a person who pays attention to dashboard warning lights, or two, you ignore dashboard warning lights. And if you pay attention to dashboard warning lights, will you please let us know in the chat? Because these people, they're the good Christians.

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他们一看到发动机故障灯、换机油提示灯亮起，就会采取适当的应对措施。如果你就是这样的人，那挺好的。我敢说，你以前一定是个优秀的童子军。如果你是那种会无视警示灯的人，我也希望你把这个发在聊天区里，因为我想知道哪些人和我一样，因为你们都是自己人。我那位了不起的妻子凯西认为，这是我性格上的一大缺陷，我也接受她的批评。但当我的仪表盘警示灯亮起时，我并不把它看作一道命令。

They see the engine light, the change-oil light, and they respond appropriately. And if you're that person, good for you. I bet you were an excellent Boy or Girl Scout. And if you're the type of person who ignores the warning lights, I want you to put that in the chat too, because I want to know who my people are, because you're my people. My wonderful wife, Kathy, thinks this is one of my major character flaws, and I accept her rebuke. But when my dashboard light goes on, I don't view it as a command.

00:01:56 - 00:02:29

我更把它看作一种建议，就像牙医发来的电子邮件一样。凯茜会说：“嘿，道格，你的警示灯亮了。”我会自信地回答：“亲爱的，那个警示灯从奥巴马政府时期起就一直亮着。“车没问题。”但忽视警示灯的问题在于，最终，警示灯就不再只是小小的灯，而会变成大型拖车，如果当时车里只有我一个人，那倒还好当时车在棕榈泉附近抛锚了，气温高达华氏110度。但我并不是一个人。

I view it more like a suggestion, like an email from my dentist. And Kathy will say, “Hey, Doug, your warning light is on.” And I confidently reply with, “Babe, that warning light has been on since the Obama administration. The car is fine.” But the problem with ignoring warning lights is that eventually, the warning lights stop being little lights, and they start being big tow trucks, which would be fine if I was in the car alone when it broke down near Palm Springs in 110-degree heat. But I wasn't alone.

00:02:29 - 00:03:02

就在那一刻，Kathy看着我——我永远都忘不了——她的眼神分明是在说：“准备办离婚手续吧。”我之所以告诉你们这些，是因为今天我们要认识一个人。他收到了整本圣经中最强烈的警示信号却还是继续开下去。不幸的是，这家伙让我觉得有点像我或许也有那么一点像你，足以让你感到不自在。我们讲到《民数记》的第七周，我们看到以色列人在旷野漂流了将近40年。他们正处于我们所说的“过渡期”。

And Kathy looked at me at that moment—I'll never forget—with eyes that really said, like, “Divorce proceedings.” And I tell you this because today, we're going to meet someone who got the most dramatic warning light in the entire Bible and kept driving anyway. And unfortunately, this guy reminds me a little of myself and probably just enough of you to make you uncomfortable. We are in week seven in the book of Numbers, where we find the Israelites in the wilderness for almost 40 years. They're in what we're calling the in-between.

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这段过渡期：从他们被救出埃及之后，到他们进入应许之地之前。我们一直在学习，我们的处境与他们相似。上帝创造了我们，但我们却使自己沦为罪的奴隶。而对于我们这些信靠耶稣在十字架上所成就之事的人来说，我们已经得救了。有一天，祂会带我们回到永恒的家。但此时此刻，我们正身处属灵的过渡阶段，在我们得救与回归天家之间。而《民数记》为我们提供了在这段过渡时期生活的重要原则。

The in-between: after their rescue from Egypt and before they enter the Promised Land. And we've been learning that our situation is similar to theirs. God created us, but we got ourselves enslaved to sin. And for those of us who have trusted what Jesus did on the cross, we've been rescued. And one day, He will bring us to our forever home. But right now, we live in the spiritual in-between, between our rescue and our heavenly homecoming. And Numbers gives us great principles for living in the in-between.

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现在，如果你手边有圣经，请翻到民数记第22章。而我接到的任务，是讲解三章的内容。这整个系列中，没有其他人被要求讲解三章。比如上周，Steve Bang Lee只讲了六节经文。六节。我得讲三章，也就是114节经文。但我明白，我明白。就像是，重活儿交给我。没问题。准备好了吗？好，因为上帝的子民——两百多万以色列人——已经迁徙了将近四十年。在第22章，我们看到他们在一个叫摩押的地方附近安营。

Now, if you have your Bible, turn to Numbers chapter 22. And I have been tasked to cover three chapters. Nobody else in this whole series has been asked to cover three chapters. Like last week, Steve Bang Lee had six verses. Six verses. I got three chapters, which is 114 verses. But I get it. I get it. Like, leave the heavy lifting to me. No problem. You ready? Okay, because God's people—more than two million Israelites—have been on the move for almost 40 years. And in chapter 22, we find them camped out near a place called Moab.

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摩押王非常害怕以色列人会消灭他。民数记第22章第1节这样说。以色列人起行，在摩押平原安营在约旦河边、耶利哥对面的摩押平原。西拨的儿子巴勒——这名字真棒——看见了以色列人向亚摩利人所行的一切事。摩押因这百姓人数众多，就大大惧怕。于是，摩押因以色列人而恐惧。于是，摩押人对米甸的长老说：“这群人要吞噬我们周围的一切，就像牛吃尽田间的青草一样。”

And the king of Moab is terrified that the Israelites will destroy him. And it says this in chapter 22, verse 1. The Israelites traveled and camped in the plains of Moab near the Jordan across from Jericho. Now Balak, son of Zippor—what a great name—saw all that Israel had done to the Amorites. And Moab was terrified of the people because they were numerous. So Moab dreaded the Israelites. So the Moabites said to the elders of Midian, “This horde will devour everything around us like an ox eats up the green plants in the field.”

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这正好形容了上周初中生小组在我家所做的是。但由于西拨的儿子巴勒当时是摩押王，他就差遣使者到毗夺，去见比珥的儿子巴兰；比珥的儿子巴兰住在他本国幼发拉底河边的毗夺。作王的巴勒对他说：“看哪，有一族人从埃及出来了。他们遮满了地面，如今就住在我的对面。我的请求是：请你来替我咒诅这些人因为他们比我强大。”

which describes what the junior high group did at my house last week. But since Balak, son of Zippor, was Moab's king at the time, he sent messengers to Balaam, son of Beor, at Pethor, which is by the Euphrates in the land of his people. Balak, who's the king, said to him, "Look, a people has come out of Egypt. They cover the surface of the land, and they're living right across from me. Here's the request: Please come and put a curse on these people for me because they are more powerful than I am."

00:05:23 - 00:05:55

或许我能击败他们，把他们赶出这片土地，因为我知道，你为谁祝福，谁就蒙福；你咒诅谁，谁就受咒诅。”所以，在神的话语中，我们看到一位惊恐的王巴勒，他选择的武器并不是刀剑。他名叫巴兰。巴兰——你可以把他看作一个受雇的先知。他是个异教先知，是个自由职业者。我觉得，他算是个收费高昂的顾问。就是说，王不是想雇他去杀掉以色列人。

I may be able to defeat them and drive them out of the land, for I know that those you bless are blessed and those you curse are cursed." So in God's Word, we've got a scared king, Balak, whose weapon of choice isn't a sword. It's a man named Balaam. And Balaam—think of him like he's a prophet for hire. He's a pagan prophet. He's a freelancer. He's, I think, an expensive consultant. Like, the king doesn't want to hire him to kill the Israelites.

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他想雇他来咒诅以色列人。人们相信，咒诅会给被咒诅的对象带来不幸。显然，巴兰声名显赫，因为王说：“你祝福谁，谁就蒙福；你咒诅谁，谁就受咒诅。”现在，花点时间想想这份工作，因为我还挺想要这份差事的。就是，拿钱去祝福或咒诅别人。就像：“我祝福你。我祝福你。”但你却在客厅里用手机看足球我讲道的时候，你却在看足球，我诅咒你。愿你的脑腐烂得更深。”

He wants to hire him to curse them. And a curse was believed to bring misfortune to the intended target. And apparently Balaam had a powerful reputation, since the king said, like, “Whoever you bless is blessed, and whoever you curse is cursed.” Now think about that job for just a minute, because I would kind of love that gig. Like, getting paid to either bless or curse people. Like, “I bless you. I bless you. But you in the living room watching soccer on your phone while I'm preaching, I curse you. May your brain rot grow deep.”

00:06:28 - 00:07:04

那可真是一份绝妙的职业。总之，王派使者带着钱还有给巴兰的任务说明，但巴兰没有收下这笔钱。他其实为这件事求问了上帝，这多少有点令人惊讶，因为巴兰并不是一个敬畏上帝的人。巴兰不过是聪明到懂得会去求问雇用他的人的神明。他祷告，上帝也回应了他的祷告。第22章第12节：神对巴兰说：“你不可同他们去，你不可咒诅这百姓，因为他们是蒙福的。”

That would be such a fantastic occupation. Anyway, the king sends his messengers with money and a job description to Balaam, but Balaam doesn't grab the money. He actually asks God about it, which is a little surprising, because Balaam is not a God-fearing man. Balaam was just smart enough to consult the gods of whoever hired him. And he prays, and God answers his prayers. Chapter 22, verse 12: Then God said to Balaam, “You are not to go with them. You are not to curse this people, for they are blessed.”

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于是巴兰起身——好，我先在这里停一下。你有没有注意到，神的回应中有任何转圜的余地？因为神的回应已经再清楚不过了。就是说，你不可去；也不可咒诅。这毫无奥秘可言，一切都清清楚楚。于是巴兰说：“好吧，听着，不，我不会咒诅神的百姓。”但当这话传回王那里时，他做了那些有钱、有权又绝望的人会做的事。他竟然派回了一个规模更大、一支更庞大、更有声望的使者队伍。

So Balaam got up— well, let me just pause right there a second. Do you notice any wiggle room in God's response? Because that's about as clear as it gets. Like, you are not to go; you're not to curse. There's no mystery. There's all clarity. So Balaam says, “Okay, look, no, I won't curse God's people.” But when that word gets back to the king, he does what rich and powerful and desperate people do. He actually sends back a bigger, more prestigious group of messengers.

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就好比，二队没把事情办成，所以，让我们把校队主力派回去吧。我们来看第22章第15节。经文说：“巴勒又差遣使臣，比先前的更多，而且职位比先前那些人更高。他们来到巴兰那里，对他说：“西拨的儿子巴勒这样说：”不要让任何事拦阻你到我这里来，因为我必使你大得尊荣，并且你向我要什么，我就为你做什么。所以，请你来替我咒诅这些百姓。但巴兰对巴勒的臣仆回答说：即使巴勒把他满屋的金银都给我，我也不能违背耶和華我神的命令去做任何或大或小的事。

Like, the JV team didn't get it done, so let's send the varsity squad back. And we're in chapter 22, verse 15. It says, “Balak sent officials again who were more numerous and higher in rank than the others. They came to Balaam and they said to him, ‘This is what Balak, son of Zippor, says:’” Let nothing keep you from coming to me, for I will greatly honor you and do whatever you ask me. So please come and put a curse on these people for me. But Balaam responded to the servants of Balak, If Balak were to give me his house full of silver and gold, I could not go against the command of the Lord my God to do anything small or great.

00:08:28 - 00:09:02

现在，先在这里稍微停顿一下。想象一下这里停顿一下，像是“嗯……”然后他说：请像其他人一样在这里过夜，好让我知道主还有什么话要告诉我。所以，巴兰没有说：“我已经得到答案了。”不，我的答案是：神说不行。他说的是：“你们知道吗？”让我先考虑一晚。让我再去问问上帝，看看祂是否祂会不会给出不同的答案。而这正是我看见的其中一处你我就藏在这个故事里。

Now put kind of a pause there. Imagine a pause, like a hmm. Then he says this: Please stay here overnight, as the others did, so I might find out what else the Lord has to tell me. So instead of Balaam saying, I already have my answer. No, my answer is no from God. What he says is, you know what, you guys? Let me sleep on it. Let me get back to God to see if he has a different answer. And this is one of the places where I see you and I hiding in this story.

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你看，巴兰已经得到了神明确的答复，但当对方开出的条件更加优厚、更具诱惑力时，巴兰的心从聆听上帝转而寻找漏洞。你不明白什么是漏洞。你我都善于钻空子。基督徒很擅长这一套。找个漏洞来支持我们最终想在生活中做的事。如果你去过好市多，你就明白什么是钻空子。你走进好市多时心想，我只是来买纸巾的，尽管我知道这一趟会花掉我200美元。

See, Balaam already had God's clear answer, but when the offer got bigger and more seductive, Balaam's heart moved from listening to God to looking for a loophole. You don't understand what a loophole is. You and I, we're quick for loopholes. Christians are great at this. Find a loophole to support what ultimately we want to do in our life. If you've ever been to Costco, you understand loopholes. You walk into Costco thinking, I'm just here for the paper towels, even though I know it's going to cost me \$200.

00:09:35 - 00:10:09

而且一走进去，你就像被什么东西控制住了，你满脑子想的就只有免费试吃，对吧？迷你塔可让你一次次折返在同一条过道里来来回回。你吃完一份试吃品，然后在过道里走来走去，你摘下帽子，戴上墨镜，换个角度靠近，伪装一下你的声音。哦，不好意思，请问这是照烧鸡肉吗？然后，那个戴着发网的人说：是啊，确实很好吃，而且这是你试吃的第五份了，对吧？没人会走进好市多时想着：我要占好市多的便宜。

And once you walk inside, something takes over you, and all you can think of is free samples, right? The mini tacos have you going back and forth down the same aisle. You consume a sample, then you walk around the aisle, you remove your hat, put on sunglasses, approach from a different angle, disguise your voice. Oh, excuse me, is this the teriyaki chicken? And the person wearing a hairnet says, Yeah, it is, and this is your fifth sample, right? Nobody goes into Costco thinking, I am going to cheat Costco.

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相反，我们会告诉自己，你知道，它们是免费的。它们想让我吃掉整整一盒。你看，我们竟会变得如此有创意，真是奇妙。当我们真的很想要某样东西时。如果你是基督徒，你很可能知道神的话语说你应当如何度过自己的一生。但当你不喜欢上帝的答案时，你就换一种方式来问，希望能得到不同的答案。我也这样做过。而当我这样做时，它立刻显露出我属灵上的不成熟。因为这正是心智不成熟的孩子会做的事。

Instead, we tell ourselves, you know, they're free. They want me to have an entire box. See, it's amazing how creative we become when we really want something. And if you're a Christian, you most likely know what God's Word says that you should do with your life. But when you don't like God's answer, you ask it in a different way, hoping for a different answer. I've done this too. And when I do, it immediately reveals my spiritual immaturity. Because this is what immature children do.

00:10:39 - 00:11:12

就像父母对孩子说，好了，宝贝，我们五分钟后就要走了。那个孩子不会回答说：好的，谢谢您，我体贴又仁慈的家长大人。我顺从地接受你们的决定并会站在门边带着积极的态度，在门边做好出发的准备。不，那个孩子立刻变成了律师马上就开始讨价还价。但当我们仰望上帝的话语，寻求如何生活的明确指引时，我相信我们有足够的智慧能明白上帝所说的话。

Like when a parent says to a child, Okay, buddy, we're going to leave in five minutes. That child doesn't reply with, Okay, thank you, my thoughtful and gracious parental unit. I obediently accept your decree and will be standing by the door with a positive attitude in preparation for our departure. No, that child turns into an attorney and starts negotiating right away. But when we look to God's Word for clarity on how to live, I believe that we're smart enough to understand what God says.

00:11:12 - 00:11:47

只是我们并不总是足够有智慧去愿意贯彻到底。并不是上帝的答案不清楚。只是祂的答案不受欢迎。想想你想买的那个东西但你知道那超出了你的预算。不管是什么，可能是那双新鞋或是重新装修，或是买艘新船。你知道，你并不是在祷告：主啊，如果买这艘鲈鱼钓鱼船不合乎你的旨意，求你让这家经销店烧毁求你让它在我明天签合同之前烧掉。不，你会祷告说：上帝啊，求你让我对这次购买感到平安。

We're just not always wise enough to want to follow through. It's not that God's answers are unclear. It's just that His answers are unwelcome. Think about the purchase that you want that you know doesn't fit into your budget. Whatever it is, it's the new shoes or the remodel or the new boat. You know, you're not praying, Lord, if buying this bass boat is outside of Your will, please let the dealership burn down before I sign the contract tomorrow. No, you're praying, God, please give me peace about this purchase.

00:11:48 - 00:12:25

但你不需要平安。你需要的是一张电子表格。大多数基督徒，我们并不是听不见。我们有的是心的问题宁可偏行己路，追逐我们想要的，也不愿顺服神对我们的旨意。神已经清楚地告诉了巴兰，但巴兰一心只想要自己想要的。第二天，他便启程前往摩押去收取那笔钱。第22章，第22节。但神因巴兰前去而发怒，耶和华的使者便站在路上站在路上阻挡他。

But you don't need peace. You need a spreadsheet. Most Christians, we don't have a hearing problem. We have a heart problem that would rather wander toward what we want than obey what God wants for us. And God was clear with Balaam, But Balaam wants what he wants. And the next day he begins his travel to Moab to now collect the money. Chapter 22, verse 22. But God was incensed that Balaam was going, and the angel of the Lord took his stand on the path to oppose him.

00:12:26 - 00:13:04

巴兰骑着他的驴，他的两个仆人也和他同行。当驴看见耶和华的使者站在路上，手里拿着出鞘的刀，驴就离开道路，走进田间。于是巴兰打驴，要叫它回到路上。当耶和华的使者站在葡萄园之间的一条狭窄小路上两边都有石墙，驴看见了耶和华的使者就贴着墙挤过去，把巴兰的脚挤在墙上，于是他又打了驴一次。耶和华的使者走到前面站在一处狭窄的地方那里狭窄，无法向左或向右转身。

Balaam was riding his donkey, and his two servants were with him. When the donkey saw the angel of the Lord standing on the path with a drawn sword in his hand, she turned off the path and went into the field. So Balaam hit her to return her to the path. When the angel of the Lord stood in a narrow passage between the vineyards with a stone wall on either side, the donkey saw the angel of the Lord and pressed herself against the wall, squeezing Balaam's foot against it, so he hit her once again. The angel of the Lord went ahead and stood in a narrow place where there was no room to turn to the right or to the left.

00:13:04 - 00:13:46

驴看见耶和华的使者时，驴就伏在巴兰身下，于是他勃然大怒，用杖打驴。现在，我们先在这里停一下，因为这段经文包含了很多信息。比如，为什么神要特意说明那头驴是母的，对吧？这就很奇怪了。还有，别生我的气。别给我写信。这是上帝在编纂时作出的决定。所以，要理论就找他，好吗？然后，上帝做了一件事是祂之前和之后都从未做过的。第28节：耶和華使驴开口，她问巴兰：“我向你做了什么你为什么这三次打我呢？”

And when the donkey saw the angel of the Lord, she crouched down under Balaam, so he became furious and beat the donkey with a stick. Now, let's pause there for a second, because there's a lot in that text. Like, for example, why does God make it known that the donkey was a female, right? Like, that's weird. And don't get mad at me. Don't write me letters. That's God's editorial decision. Like, take it up with him, okay? And then God does something he's never done before or since. Verse 28: Then the Lord opened the donkey's mouth, and she asked Balaam, "What have I done to you that you have beaten me these three times?"

00:13:47 - 00:14:26

巴兰回答驴说：“你让我看起来像个傻瓜。要是我手里有刀，我现在就杀了你。”但驴说：“我不是你一生骑到今日的驴吗？我以前曾这样对待过你吗？”“没有，”巴兰回答说。于是，耶和華使巴兰的眼睛明亮，他就看见耶和华的使者站在路上手里拿着出鞘的刀。巴兰俯伏跪下，脸伏于地敬拜。耶和华的使者问他：“你为什么这三次打你的驴呢？看哪，我出来阻挡你，因为我看你所做的是恶事。”

Balaam answered the donkey, "You made me look like a fool. If I had a sword in my hand, I'd kill you now." But the donkey said, "Am I not the donkey you've ridden your whole life until today? Have I ever treated you this way before?" "No," Balaam replied. Then the Lord opened Balaam's eyes, and he saw an angel of the Lord standing in the path with a drawn sword in his hand. Balaam knelt low and bowed in worship on his face. The angel of the Lord asked him, "Why have you beaten your donkey these three times? Look, I came out to oppose you because I consider what you are doing to be evil."

00:14:26 - 00:14:58

他在做什么？他无视上帝的命令，还想趁机捞一笔钱去咒诅以色列。他说：“驴看见了我，三次转身躲开我。如果她没有躲开我，我早就把你杀了，却会让她活着。”现在，这头会说话的驴——别想到迪士尼，好吗？要想到的是神性。就像，这是神在施展作为。这是一个震撼人心的神迹，为要保护祂所爱的人。

What's he doing? He's ignoring God's command, and he's taking a money grab to curse Israel. He says, "The donkey saw me and turned away from me these three times. If she had not turned away from me, I would have killed you by now and let her live." Now, this talking donkey— don't think Disney, okay? Think deity. Like, this is God in action. It's a dramatic miracle to protect those he loves.

00:14:59 - 00:15:33

而且我觉得很耐人寻味的是，当巴兰的驴开始说话时，巴兰既没有尖叫，也没有晕倒。相反，他只是立刻回嘴驴子，仿佛这种互动每周二都会发生一样。比如，他的驴开口说话了，而他的第一反应竟然是要争个输赢。现在，如果我的狗突然抬头看着我，说，“道格，我们得谈谈你忽视你车上的警示灯这件事以及离婚可能会付出多么昂贵的代价，”我不会反驳。我的反应会是赶紧跑出去逃出那栋被鬼附的房子。但巴兰却没有。

And I find it fascinating that when Balaam's donkey starts talking, Balaam, he doesn't scream, he doesn't faint. Instead, he just fires back at the donkey like this type of interaction happens every Tuesday. Like, his donkey talks, and the first instinct is to win the argument. Now, if my dog suddenly looked up at me and said, "Doug, we need to talk about you ignoring the warning lights in your car and how expensive divorce could be," I would not respond with a rebuttal. I would respond by running out of that demon-possessed house. But not Balaam.

00:15:33 - 00:16:07

你看，他的心如此执着于自己想要的东西，天使称之为邪恶。他一心只想着自己的报酬以至于他错过了就在眼前的神迹。朋友们，这就是贪婪对人心所做的事。它让你一心只想着自己想要的，以至于你竟错过了神同在的时刻就在你眼前。我们希望神赐福我们的生命，但我们非但没有聆听并遵行上帝的道路，我们却在鞭打自己的驴，然后又责怪别人把自己的人生变成这样归咎于别人。

See, his heart is so locked into what his heart wants, which the angel called evil. He's so focused on his payday that he misses the miracle right in front of him. And that, my friends, is what greed does to a heart. It makes you fixated on what you want, that you actually miss the God moments right in front of you. We want God's blessing on our life, but instead of listening and following God's ways, we're beating our donkey and then blaming others for how our life has turned out.

00:16:07 - 00:16:43

所以，让我稍微往后快进一点，快进到巴兰的故事中，因为即使在会说话的驴发出警告之后，巴兰前往摩押，要咒诅以色列。但每次他一开口，想要咒诅，出口的却是祝福。这样的事一共发生了三次。所以请务必自己在圣经中读一读这些内容。它们被称为巴兰的诗歌或巴兰的神谕。你可能也猜到了，王勃然大怒。他说：“是啊，我花钱请你诅咒我的敌人，可你所做的却只是祝福他们。”

So let me fast forward just a little bit into Balaam's story, because even after the talking donkey warning, Balaam travels to Moab to curse Israel. But what happens is every time he opens his mouth for a cursing, a blessing comes out. And this happens three different times. So be sure to read these on your own in your Bible. They're called the poems of Balaam or the oracles of Balaam. And as you might guess, the king is furious. He says, "Yeah, I'm paying you to curse my enemies, and all you're doing is blessing them."

00:16:43 - 00:17:21

于是，他让巴兰回家。但在巴兰离开之前，他吟诵了第四首诗以及第四个预言，其中他描述了以色列的未来将战胜摩押。我只想让你们看这一节经文中的一小部分就在民数记24章第9节，因为这非常耐人寻味。他在诗中这样说：“我看见他，却不是现在。我望见他，却不在近时。有星要出于雅各，有一根权杖要从以色列兴起。”

So he tells Balaam to go home. But before Balaam leaves, he has a fourth poem and a fourth prophecy where he describes Israel's future victory over Moab. And I just want you to see one slice of one verse in Numbers 24, verse 9, because it's fascinating. He says this in his poem: "I see him, but not now. I perceive him, but not near. A star will come from Jacob, and a scepter will rise from Israel."

00:17:22 - 00:17:55

你知道巴兰说的是谁吗？他所说的就是耶稣。那张受贿要咒诅以色列的嘴却被神掌控，用来宣告耶稣的降临。我的意思是，这实在让我觉得太奇妙了。如果到明天，你忘了我这篇讲道的90%，你们肯定会忘，而且即便你是个表现超群的人，也不例外，我希望你努力记住这个大有能力的真理。就是这一点：神所赐福的，无人能咒诅。神所赐福的，无人能咒诅。现在就在心里默念这句话。

Do you know who Balaam is talking about? He's talking about Jesus. The very mouth that was bribed to curse Israel gets hijacked by God to announce the coming of Jesus. I mean, that is just awesome to me. And if you forget 90% of my sermon by tomorrow, which you will, and that's even if you're an overachiever, I want you to try to remember this one powerful truth. Here it is: What God blesses, no one can curse. What God blesses, no one can curse. Just say that over in your head right now.

00:17:55 - 00:18:41

神所赐福的，没有人能咒诅。这对你如此重要，原因就在这里。因为在生活中，会有人与你作对，但他们无法封杀你。他们可以控告你，但无法定你的罪。因为神所赐福的，就一直蒙福。比如，你已蒙赦免，你已被救赎，你得救了，你被拣选了，你被爱着。你已经成为新造的人。神所赐福的，没有人能咒诅。如果你已经信靠耶稣，就没有任何仇敌、任何诊断结果、任何过去的失败，没有任何成瘾、离婚、破产或背叛，没有任何秘密，没有任何羞耻，也没有任何人有足够的力量能推翻上帝对你生命所说的话。

What God blesses, no one can curse. And here's why this is so important for you. Because in life, people are going to come against you, but they can't cancel you. Like, they can accuse you, but they can't condemn you. Like, what God has blessed stays blessed. Like, you're forgiven, you're redeemed, you're saved, you're chosen, you're loved. You've been made new. And what God blesses, no one can curse. Like, if you've put your faith in Jesus, there's no enemy, no diagnosis, no past failure, no addiction, no divorce, no bankruptcy, no betrayal, no secret, no shame, no person with enough power to undo what God has spoken about your life.

00:18:42 - 00:19:17

正因如此，使徒保罗才这样说。他说：“神若帮助我们，谁能抵挡我们呢？”所以，如果你是基督徒，你就是属祂的。你是属祂的。所以恭喜你，你很了不起。你身处一支常胜的队伍。你可以昂首挺胸地生活因为你属于祂。你可以带着属灵的自信活出你的人生，那是一种自信，而不是自大。你没有做过任何配得上自负的事。耶稣成就了一切，使你可以蒙福。

That's why the Apostle Paul said it like this. He says, "If God is for us, well, who can be against us?" So if you're a Christian, you're his. You're his. So congratulations. You got it going on. You're on a winning team. You can walk around with your shoulders back because you belong to him. You can live your life with a spiritual swagger, which is a confidence, not a cockiness. You didn't do anything to deserve to be cocky. Jesus did everything so you could be blessed.

00:19:18 - 00:19:58

这就是好消息。但不幸的是，对巴兰来说，事情并没有以好消息收场。巴兰不再替神说话了，但他并没有悄然离去。故事从这里开始急转直下，很快变得极其黑暗。民数记24章25节这样说：“于是巴兰起身，回到自己的家乡。巴勒——就是那位王——也回去了。”以色列人住在什亭的时候，百姓开始行淫乱与摩押女子行淫。

And that's the good news. But unfortunately for Balaam, it doesn't end with good news. Balaam was done speaking for God, but he didn't go away quietly. And this is where the story gets real dark, real quick. In Numbers 24, verse 25, it says this: "Then Balaam arose and went back to his homeland. And Balak—this is the king—also went his way." While Israel was staying in the Acacia Grove, the people began to prostitute themselves with the women of Moab.

00:19:59 - 00:20:31

那些妇女邀请他们参加献给她们神明的祭祀，百姓就吃了，并俯伏敬拜她们的神。于是，以色列人与毗珥的巴力联合，耶和华的怒气就向以色列人发作。所以这里发生的是，以色列人，他们违背了十诫中的第一条因为他们敬拜偶像。而且实际情况比听起来还要糟糕。因为毗珥的巴力是一个生育之神。所以，这与性有关。

The women invited them to the sacrifices for their gods, and the people ate and bowed in worship to their gods. So Israel aligned itself with Baal of Peor, and the Lord's anger burned against Israel. So what happens here is the Israelites, they violate the first of the Ten Commandments by worshiping idols. And it's actually worse than it sounds because Baal of Peor was a fertility god. So it was about sex.

00:20:31 - 00:21:10

而且，性行为并不只是在宴会上发生。事实上，性行为正是他们敬拜这个巴力的方式，这个小写的神。而这正是整场背叛如此隐蔽的原因。你看，这些女人出现时并没有说：“嘿，以色列人，你们应该离弃你们的神。”相反，那些女人以寻欢作乐的诱惑出现了。朋友们，试探就是这样运作的。撒但不会戴着名牌出现在你面前，上面写着：“嗨，我是撒但，我想毁掉你的人生，摧毁你的婚姻让你为自己的财务状况忧心忡忡。”

And sex wasn't just happening at a party. The sex was actually how they worshiped this Baal, this small-g god. And that's what makes this entire rebellion so sneaky. See, the women didn't show up saying, "Hey, Israelites, you should abandon your God." Instead, the women showed up in the form of a good time. And friends, that's how temptation works. Like, Satan doesn't show up to you wearing a name tag: "Hi, I'm Satan, and I'd like to ruin your life and destroy your marriage and make you anxious about your finances."

00:21:10 - 00:21:51

你觉得呢？”不会，你会说：“哦，嘿，撒但，退到我后边去吧。”但这不是他的惯用伎俩。他的诱饵是试探，而他的钩子却是致命的。那么，这个试探的念头是从哪里来的呢？请看。六章之后，在第31章，经文这样说：“然而，正是这些女人听从了巴兰的计谋，却在巴兰的计谋下，引诱以色列人对主不忠。”这是巴兰出的主意。巴兰无法亲口咒诅以色列，于是，他给了国王一个作战计划，好让以色列人自己招致咒诅。

What do you think?" No, you'd say, "Oh, hey, get behind me, Satan." But that's not his playbook. Like, his bait is temptation, and his hook is deadly. So where did this temptation idea come from? Watch this. Six chapters later, in chapter 31, it says this: "Yet those were the ones who, at Balaam's advice, incited the Israelites to unfaithfulness against the Lord." It was Balaam's advice. Balaam couldn't curse Israel with his mouth, so he gave the king a battle plan for how they could curse themselves."

00:21:51 - 00:22:29

但他一定对王说：“嘿，王啊，你不能正面击败这些以色列人。他们的神会保护他们。所以不要咒诅他们。相反，要引诱他们。让诱惑进入他们中间，他们就会咒诅自己。”你看，巴兰知道这世上最古老的伎俩，就是蛇在伊甸园里所用的那一招也是仇敌今天所使用的同一种策略。那么，好吧，我们能从巴兰身上学到什么功课呢？这里有很多值得我们学习的功课，但最明显的教训是：不要像巴兰那样，好吗？

But he must have told the king, “Hey, king, you can't beat these Israelites head-on. Like, their God protects them. So don't curse them. Instead, seduce them. Send in temptation, and they will curse themselves.” See, Balaam, he knew the oldest trick in the book, the same one that the serpent used in the Garden of Eden and the same strategy the enemy uses today. So, okay, what's the lesson from Balaam? And there are so many lessons here, but the obvious one is this: Don't be like Balaam, okay?

00:22:29 - 00:23:10

我真希望能把这个咖啡杯寄给你，提醒你：巴兰不是个好人。他就是个混蛋。他是个骗子。比如，如果你是年轻的父母，别给孩子取名叫巴兰，好吗？他坏到一个地步：一千五百年后，当你翻到新约时，你会看到三位新约作者都以巴兰为鉴戒。彼得说，你们知道，巴兰贪爱不义之财。犹大说，像巴兰这样的假教师为了钱财欺骗人。在《启示录》中，耶稣因教会中有错误教导而责备他们，说：“你那里有人持守巴兰的教训。”明白吗？

Like, I wish I could mail you this coffee cup to remind you: Balaam wasn't good. He was a punk. He was a fraud. Like, if you're a young parent, don't name your kid Balaam, okay? He was so bad that 1,500 years later, you flip to the New Testament, you see three New Testament writers refer to Balaam as a warning. Peter says, you know, Balaam loved to earn money by doing wrong. Jude says false teachers like Balaam, they deceive people for their money. In the book of Revelation, Jesus rebukes the church for false teaching by saying, “You have some there who hold the teaching of Balaam,” okay?

00:23:10 - 00:23:44

你明白重点了，对吧？比如，巴兰不是个好人，所以不要像巴兰一样。这听起来很简单。但当我回想自己的人生时，我发现其实很容易变得像他一样当我口中说出美好的话，内心却与之不一致时。而我很不愿意承认这一点。这种事我做过太多次了。比如，我曾一边紧攥着自己的钱包，一边讲慷慨奉献的道。比如，我一边教导饶恕的大能，一边却暗暗积攒怨恨。

You're getting the point, right? Like, Balaam is not a good person, so don't be like Balaam. And that sounds simple. But when I think about my life, it's actually very easy to be like him when good words come out of my mouth that don't align with my heart. And I hate to admit that. I've done that too often. Like, I've preached sermons on generosity while gripping my own wallet. Like, I've taught on the power of forgiveness while quietly piling up grudges.

00:23:45 - 00:24:17

我嘴上祷告说：“上帝啊，不要成就我的意思，只要成就你的意思。”但我的行动却一直在忙着确保我自己的意思得以成就。我想，我不是唯一这样的人，对吧？我敢说，你也能感同身受。如果你也有同感，能在聊天区告诉我吗？你看，我想，如果要总结这一切，我认为巴兰最大的失败就是他如此清楚地听到了神的指示，却没有遵从。

I've prayed, "Oh God, not my will, but yours," with my mouth. But my actions were busy trying to make sure that my will would be done. And I'm guessing I'm not alone, am I? And my bet is that you can relate. And if you can relate, will you let me know in the chat? See, I think if I'm summarizing this all up, I think Balaam's biggest failure was that he so clearly heard God's instructions, and he didn't follow them.

00:24:17 - 00:24:51

所以，至少对今天的我来说，这个挑战，或者说这个提醒，就是聆听神的话语，并因祂对你的爱而深受激励，或因祂对我的爱而深受激励，以至于我愿意遵行他的话。也就是说，我愿意顺服祂。就是这么简单，也这么困难。上帝因着祂的爱，将祂的话语赐给了我们。祂赐给我们祂的情书和使用说明，不是为了定罪基督徒，而是为了引导我们。引导我们走向一个更加蒙福的人生。

So the challenge, or maybe the reminder, for me today anyway, is to listen to God's word and be so inspired by his love for you, or his love for me, that I want to follow it. Like, I want to obey him. It's that simple, and it's that difficult. Like God, in his love, he gave us his word. He gave us his love letter and instruction manual, not to condemn Christians, but to guide us. To guide us toward a more blessing-filled life.

00:24:52 - 00:25:25

耶稣在《约翰福音》第13章中这样说。他说——这是耶稣说的——“你们既知道这些事，就怎么样呢？你们若去行这些事，就有福了。”如果你照着去做。比如，在基督信仰中，获取更多圣经知识并不是首要目标。你看，我们的目标是让你我都更像耶稣。上周，Steve Banglely 传讲了一篇精彩的信息讲述了上帝赐给我们、让我们可以领受的爱与恩典。你知道，这并非基于我们的努力，而是基于耶稣在十字架上的牺牲。

Jesus said it this way in John 13. He said—this is Jesus talking— “If you know these things, you are what? You're blessed if you do them.” If you do them. Like, in the Christian faith, gathering more Bible information isn't the primary goal. See, the goal is for you and me to be more like Jesus. Last week, Steve Banglely preached a beautiful message on God's love and grace for us that's available to us. You know, not based on our effort, but based on Jesus' sacrifice on the cross.

00:25:25 - 00:26:10

我很喜欢这个信息，我也不是在主张任何人认为他们真的可以靠更加努力来赢得那份爱或恩典。我只是说，对我而言，因着上帝丰盛的爱与恩宠，我愿因这爱而受激励，满怀信心地顺服并跟随祂。我跟随耶稣大约50年了，我不知道，我观察到，顺服似乎与祝福有着密切的联系。我无法充分描述这一切如何运作的奥秘，我也绝对无法为你把它归纳成一个公式，但顺服与上帝的祝福之间，似乎确实存在关联。

Like, I love that message, and I'm not advocating for anyone to think that they can actually work harder for that love or grace. I'm simply saying, for me, because of God's great love and favor, I want to be compelled to follow him with a faith-filled obedience. And I don't know, after following Jesus for about 50 years, I have observed that obedience seems intimately connected to blessings. And I can't adequately describe the mystery of how it all works, and I definitely can't put it into a formula for you, but obedience and God's blessings sure seem to be connected.

00:26:11 - 00:26:45

然而，我发现人们常常对神发怒因为他们感受不到祝福，但他们其实一直按自己的打算生活。他们钻信仰的空子，结果却感到失望因为没有得到祝福而感到失望。你希望在生命中得到上帝的赐福吗？我想要，我也希望你能得着。所以，这篇信息的主题是：“不要像巴兰一样”，这很好，很好，也值得牢记，但更深层的信息围绕着这三个词展开：聆听、顺服和祝福。

And yet I find that people get angry at God all the time because they don't feel blessed, but they're living from their own agenda. They're employing faith loopholes and then getting disappointed at their lack of blessing. Do you want God's blessing in your life? I do, and I want it for you too. So this message, "Don't be like Balaam," it's good, it's good, and it's good to remember, but the deeper message revolves around these three words: listen, obey, and blessings.

00:26:45 - 00:27:20

比如，在你的生活中，有没有哪个方面，你明知自己没有顺服，你正在悖逆神吗？在你点击进入下一个内容之前，你愿意思考一下，上帝可能正在对你说什么吗？比如，你明知道自己生活中有哪个方面你明知自己在哪方面违背了神清楚的话语？花一分钟静下来想想，并为此祷告。如果你需要祷告，我们有领袖在聊天区他们很乐意和你一起祷告。也许你需要结束一段关系或是一段你一直拒绝修复的关系。

Like, is there an area of your life where you know you're not obeying, you're being disobedient? Before you click over to whatever's next, would you think about what God may be saying to you? Like, what's an area of your life where you know you're being disobedient to God's clear word? Sit with that for a minute. Pray about it. If you need prayer, we have leaders in the chat who would love to pray with you. Maybe it's a relationship you need to end or one you've been refusing to repair.

00:27:20 - 00:27:53

也许是你处理金钱的方式，或是你在工作中的诚信，又或许，是你一直在暗中放纵某个习惯，悖逆了神。问题是：你不需要我列出清单。你已经知道自己目前在哪些事上悖逆了。圣灵很快就让你想起了这件事，紧接着，你的下一个念头就是找理由为它开脱。那个理由就是你的漏洞，也是你的警示灯。而顺服，就是去做那一件事就是去做那件你已经知道神要你做的事。

Maybe it's your handling of money or your integrity at work, or maybe being disobedient in a habit you keep feeding in the dark. Here's the thing: you don't need my list. You already know your current disobedience. The Holy Spirit quickly brought it to your mind, and then your very next thought was the reason to explain it away. That reason is your loophole. It's also your warning light. And obedience is simply doing the one thing you already know God is asking you to do.

00:27:54 - 00:28:26

你明白为什么巴兰是不顺服的例子了吗？耶稣是顺服的典范。而且因为他的顺服，这扇门已经为你我敞开，使我们可以由此进入，得以称义，这才是人生终极的福分。在《罗马书》第5章中，经文这样说：因为一个人不顺服上帝，许多人就成了罪人。但因着另一个人耶稣顺服了神，许多人都将被称为义。

You see why Balaam is an example of disobedience? Jesus is a picture of obedience. And because of his obedience, the door has been opened for you and me to walk through to be made righteous, which is the ultimate of life's blessings. In Romans 5, it says this: Because one person disobeyed God, many became sinners. But because one other person, Jesus, obeyed God, many will be made righteous.

00:28:27 - 00:29:05

耶稣完全顺服好叫我们的悖逆能被完全遮盖。所以，当我劝你们顺服时，我不是在告诉你，你需要靠行为赢得上帝的爱。你无法靠自己赢得祂的爱。相反，我邀请你回应一份你已经拥有的爱。所以，今天，当你离开屏幕时，请带着极大的信心离开那位绝不容任何人咒诅祂所赐福之人的神，也同样看顾着你，即使你身上的警示灯忽明忽暗，祂仍看着你，说：“这个人是我的。”

Jesus was perfectly obedient so that our disobedience could be completely covered. So when I challenge you with obedience, I'm not telling you you need to earn God's love. You can't earn it. Instead, I'm inviting you to respond to a love you already have. So please, today, when you leave the screen, leave with great confidence that the same God who won't let anyone curse what he has blessed looks at you, even with your flickering warning lights, and says, "This one is mine."

00:29:06 - 00:29:13

然后，他走上十字架，使这句话成为真实。

And then he went to the cross to make that true.